



**Program Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning and  
Impact Assessment (MELIA) Plan**

**Climate Action Program**

*June 2025*

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# 1. Program overview and results framework

## Program overview

The Climate Action Science Program envisions resilient food, land, and water (FLW) systems across the Global South in the face of climate change, variability, and shocks, operating equitably, and contributing to the removal of global GHG emissions. The Program aims to directly benefit 16 million vulnerable small-scale producers and value chain actors across 30 countries. The Program will build capacity across a wide range of CGIAR initiatives with public, private and civil society partners to reach over 100 million additional producers. In line with the Paris Agreement, the Program aims to contribute to the reduction, avoidance, or removal of one gigaton of CO<sub>2</sub>e, inform at least 100 policies, and influence USD15 billion in climate finance by 2030.

As CGIAR's climate hub, the Program will guide research priorities, close knowledge gaps, and promote system-wide collaboration through climate analytics, risk data, and alignment of research agendas. Research will focus on climate risk management, digital advisories, locally-led climate action, and low-emission transitions. Policy, finance, and institutional innovations will enable large-scale impact. Solutions include early warning systems; resilient landscapes, agrifood systems and water management; responsible AI-supported analytics; data and tools for improved transparency and reporting; and novel frameworks for carbon removal, methane reduction, and finance to address loss and damage.

Climate change is a multi-faceted challenge that cannot be solved in siloes or with single solutions. By bringing together CGIAR's climate work on adaptation and mitigation under one umbrella, the Climate Action Program will address climate challenges in FLW systems holistically from producer to landscape. It will also identify synergies between adaptation and mitigation and scale innovations across different production systems through policy and finance.

The Program's intended outcomes will be attained through the implementation of the five (5) interconnected Areas of Work (AoWs):

### **AoW 1: Prioritization and Coordination of Climate Action**

AoW 1 will lead an unprecedented effort in prioritization and coordination of climate action for CGIAR and its partners. Establishing The CGIAR Climate Hub, serving as the nerve center for the entire CGIAR climate activities, AoW 1 will (1) strengthen coordination and collaboration on climate research and engagement across CGIAR; (2) mainstream a just transitions lens that informs strategies and program design; (3) produce, host, and disseminate climate analytics for climate action prioritization; (4) synthesize and consolidate climate and FLW system research and action; and (5) engage in and influence international policy processes. AoW 1 will lead to a more coherent and cohesive CGIAR climate agenda, deeper partnerships at all levels, and meaningful influence on climate discourse.

### **AoW 2: Digital Advisories and Climate Risk Management**

AoW 2 strengthens proactive climate risk management by transforming climate information services (CIS) and early warning systems (EWS) into integrated, inclusive tools that support more resilient FLW systems. It builds the capacity of governments, institutional networks, and the private sector to co-

design and scale service bundles that combine climate-informed advisories, risk insurance, anticipatory cash transfers, and other forms of climate-adapted assistance. Applying a cascading risk framework, AoW 2 aims to reduce the impact of climate shocks before they occur, particularly for vulnerable groups. These efforts will embed climate risk management into national systems, laying the groundwork for adaptation and low-emission transitions, with measurable benefits across all five CGIAR Impact Areas.

### **AoW 3: Locally-led Adaptation (LLA)**

AoW 3 will strengthen the capacities of local institutions to design, implement, and scale inclusive adaptation solutions that reflect the priorities of small-scale producers, particularly women, youth, and marginalized groups. It will support LLA by developing tools and approaches that address social and gender inequalities in climate risk exposure, while building mechanisms to finance LLA and improve access to funding. AoW 3 will also help integrate locally developed solutions into national and global policy processes and support development partners and implementers with frameworks to avoid maladaptation and assess trade-offs with mitigation and social inclusion goals. Social inclusion will be mainstreamed throughout engagement and scaling efforts to ensure adaptation is equitable, context-specific, and sustainable.

### **AoW 4: Low-emission Transitions**

AoW 4 will support low-emission development in target countries by enhancing carbon sequestration, reducing current greenhouse gas emissions, and avoiding future emissions to contribute to 2030 mitigation targets. Working with partners, it will strengthen implementation of national and local climate commitments (including NDCs) and mobilize climate finance that benefits small-scale producers. The AoW will co-develop science-based tools, approaches, and socio-technological bundles to guide the low-emission transition of food systems, while promoting uptake by public and private sector actors. It will also advance a just transition by increasing the participation and agency of women, youth, and marginalized groups in shaping and benefiting from climate mitigation strategies, with recommendations to ensure equitable inclusion in related policies, programs, and investment decisions.

### **AoW 5: Finance and Policy for Scaling Solutions**

AoW 5 will strengthen national climate policy development and reporting, while integrating climate considerations into sectoral policies and investment decisions. It will improve access to public and private finance—including emerging mechanisms such as the Loss and Damage Fund and carbon markets—by generating decision-ready insights and addressing critical data gaps. The AoW focuses on mobilizing large-scale climate and development finance, including that which supports just transitions, to ensure marginalized populations and fragile states benefit equitably. In alignment with the evolving global climate finance landscape—including the New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) under the UNFCCC—AoW 5 will work through strategic partnerships with governments, financial institutions, and the private sector to support policy implementation and unlock investment in climate action by 2030. Drawing on inputs from other AoWs—including adaptation and mitigation priorities (AoW 1), CIS roadmaps (AoW 2), and low-emission business models (AoW 4)—AoW 5 connects prioritized science to scaled action.

## Theory of change

The Climate Action Program envisions harmonized and equitable climate action across FLW systems, contributing to both international and national goals on climate adaptation and mitigation. It aims to support the objectives of the Paris Agreement by specifically targeting three foundational pillars:

1. The Global Goal on Adaptation (Article 7.1), which calls for strengthened resilience, enhanced adaptive capacity, and reduced vulnerability;
2. Article 2.1(c), which emphasizes aligning financial flows with low-emission, climate-resilient development;
3. Article 2.1(a), which commits to limiting global temperature rise through substantial GHG reductions and removals.

The Program builds on the learnings and achievements of CGIAR's Research Programs (e.g., Climate Change, Agriculture and Food Security; Forests, Trees and Agroforestry), as well as Portfolio 22 Initiatives (e.g., ClimBeR, Mitigate+, Impact Platform) to deliver place-based solutions to global, national, and local stakeholders along CGIAR's three strategic impact pathways: innovation, capacity change, policy change.

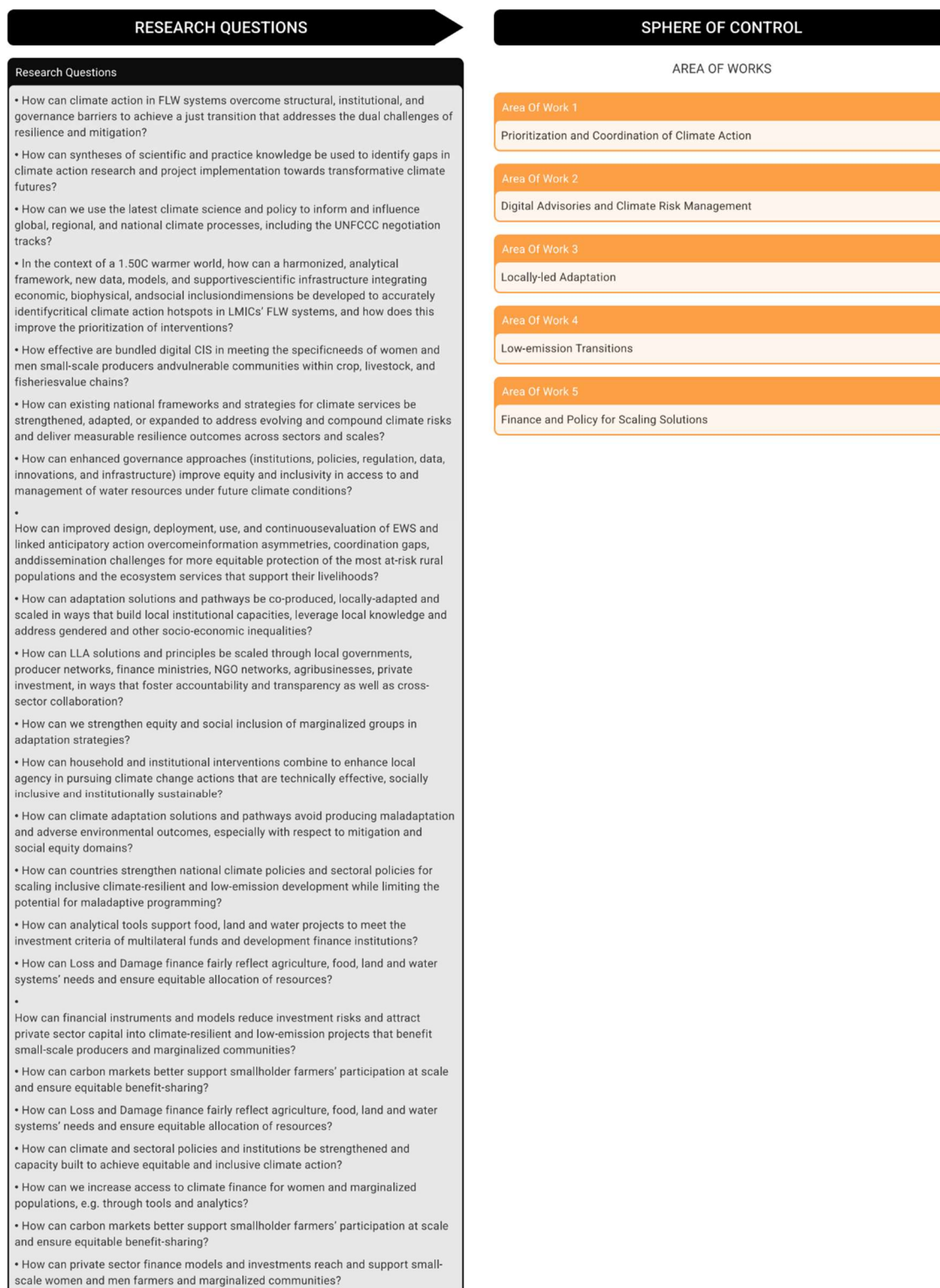
By 2030, the Program aims to achieve End-of-Portfolio outcomes across four key thematic areas: (1) Producers and other FLW system actors adopt climate adaptation and low-emission solutions; (2) Public and private sector actors mobilize new financing for just, low-emission climate action and equitable transitions; (3) Climate and sectoral policies are informed by robust climate data and evidence; and (4) Systemic change is enabled in the research approaches of public and civil society actors through strengthened institutional capacity to integrate locally led adaptation, low-emission solutions, and evidence-based tracking of climate policies into climate change responses.

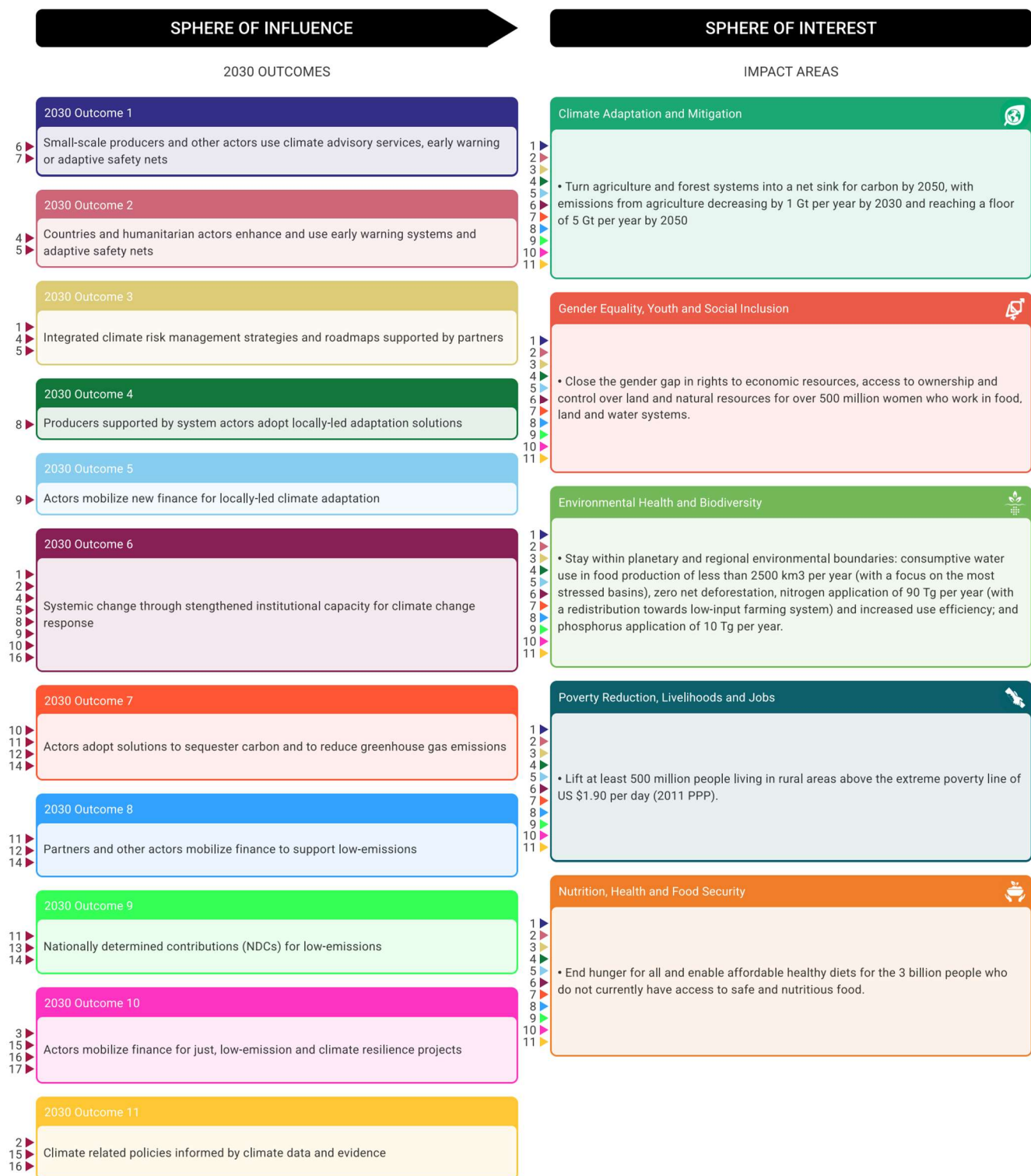
The End-of-Portfolio outcomes will be achieved by facilitating science- and evidence-based prioritization and coordination of inclusive climate action through impactful research, data and knowledge synthesis, and multi-stakeholder engagement. These efforts aim to guide a just climate transition toward more resilient FLW systems. The Program seeks to close knowledge and capacity gaps among international, national, and local stakeholders by providing tailored capacity development and information to strengthen their ability to design, implement, and track policies, strategies, projects, and processes for climate adaptation and mitigation.

Enabling systemic change through strengthened institutional and actor capacity is central to positioning the Program to reach and benefit small-scale producers—including women, youth, and marginalized groups—as well as value chain actors, thereby ensuring inclusive impacts at scale. To drive and sustain long-term, systemic capacity change, the Program will ensure that tools, frameworks, methodologies, climate-risk management strategies, and socio-technological innovations are accessible to and utilized by FLW actors and producers. These efforts will be complemented by the integration of climate, gender, and social inclusion data, insights, and evidence to support harmonized and equitable climate action. Through multi-stakeholder collaboration and system-wide capacity sharing, the Program aims to effectively influence climate policies, negotiations, and financing.

In addition to influencing capacity and policy change at all levels, the Program will catalyze the sustained adoption of climate adaptation and low-emission solutions among FLW actors and small-scale producers by designing and delivering human-centric, context-specific, and socially inclusive climate information products, services, and innovations. These demand-driven climate solutions will be developed and delivered through participatory processes and research approaches anchored in the principles of co-design and/or locally led adaptation. These mechanisms ensure that climate solutions are tailored to meet the specific needs of the targeted FLW actors.

# Climate Action Program's Theory of Change







## Results framework

Aligned with the Program's updated ToC, the results framework outlines the identified indicators per result and corresponding targets. It further specifies monitoring, and evaluation approaches that document and assess progress toward each indicator target to inform performance review and adaptive management. This guides the overall MELIA Plan, particularly the data collection strategy, MELIA studies, and other MELIA activities in target countries in close collaboration with other Programs, Accelerators, and bilateral projects.

Refer to the Results Framework attachment for additional information.

## 2. Monitoring plan for high-level outputs (HLOs) and outcomes

### Data collection strategy

The Climate Action Program will adopt a monitoring-for-learning approach grounded in results-based management (RBM) principles and aligned with CGIAR's Performance and Results Management Framework (PRMF). Progress will be tracked against defined indicators and targets as outlined in the Program's Results Framework. Ongoing activities, as reflected in updated AoW plans, will be monitored through the active participation of the MEL team in regular AoW, Program, and Leadership meetings, as well as periodic Program-level engagement events. Through consistent internal engagement, outputs from completed activities will be systematically documented, reflected upon and used to inform adaptive learning and decision-making. This strategy veers away from traditional monitoring and reporting for compliance.

In addition, the MEL Team, in collaboration with the IA Team, will design an internal monitoring system that fosters a culture of documentation and evidence-based reporting of activities and outputs. This system—comprising tools such as monitoring sheets, data capture forms, activity templates, and repositories—will enable Program implementers to collect and share key information (e.g., activity objectives, participants, and partners involved), as well as evidence of completed activities and resulting outputs or outcomes. The Program will leverage Artificial Intelligence (AI) to reduce the burden on scientists and increase the quality of reports. The collected information will be synthesized and reviewed quarterly to provide timely feedback to Program leadership and AoWs. This process ensures that implementation gaps are promptly identified and addressed through informed corrective actions, supporting the timely delivery of outputs.

The design and data requirements of the internal monitoring system will be aligned with CGIAR's Performance and Results Management System (PRMS) to ensure efficient and streamlined results reporting. The Program will leverage the capabilities of PRMS's online reporting platforms and tools (e.g., Results Dashboard) to track annual performance against defined indicators and targets. Documented results—both outputs and outcomes—will be reported in the system against relevant indicators, enabling the Program to assess its achievements relative to targets through variance analysis. This analysis will help measure progress and identify areas where the Program is lagging, facilitating timely course correction.

Data quality for both the internal monitoring system and reporting to the PRMS will be ensured through a system of checks and balances involving various implementing groups. The MEL and IA Teams will engage data providers (AoWs, implementers, and reporting officers) throughout the development of the internal monitoring system to ensure their understanding of its design and purpose. These groups will also be capacitated on data quality standards, reporting processes, and the use of reporting templates. Internal data quality assurance will be conducted regularly by the MEL and IA Teams through systematic data reviews, ensuring the reliability and consistency of reported results. Reporting quality and timeliness will be considered as part of RBM in terms of operational efficiency and effectiveness.

For monitoring or evaluating outcomes not covered by MELIA studies (Annex 1), the Program will employ cost-efficient qualitative methods, taking resource constraints into account. Depending on the indicator, these methods will include evidence of outcomes, document or text analysis, review of partners' records and reports, and feedback documentation. The Program will leverage strategic engagement—such as capacity development, workshops, and short interviews—with partners to capture and document emerging outcomes whenever possible. This outcome documentation will complement the MELIA studies (Annex 1) to provide evidence of the Program's contribution through its activities, outputs, and intermediate outcomes toward the 2030 outcomes and impacts.

To ensure efficient delivery of the monitoring plan and data collection strategy, the roles and expectations for different groups in the Program are outlined in the table below:

| <b>Implementing group</b>        | <b>Personnel</b>                             | <b>Expected roles for MELIA</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Leadership/<br>AoW leads         | Permanent<br>Director & AoW<br>leads         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Provide strategic guidance on ToC, results framework and key data collection points</li> <li>• Validate collected data for reporting</li> <li>• Review CGIAR technical reports</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| MELIA task<br>group              | Todd Rosenstock<br>John Choptiany            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Provide technical guidance on monitoring strategy and plans for data collection, synthesis and communication</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| MEL Team                         | Valerien Pede<br>Justin Dela Rueda           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Co-design internal monitoring system (data capture forms, activity report templates, evidence repositories)</li> <li>• Capacitate relevant internal groups on in the internal monitoring systems</li> <li>• Facilitate collection, review, quality assurance and synthesis of monitoring data, evidence and insights</li> <li>• Support the design and conduct of MELIA studies</li> </ul> |
| IA Team                          | Byron Reyes<br>Enoch Kikulwe<br>Karen Camilo | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Lead the design and conduct of MELIA studies (evaluation and impact assessment)</li> <li>• Collaborate and provide support to MEL functions to ensure alignment with evaluation and IA plans</li> <li>• Synthesize and provide data and evidence of outcomes/impacts for reporting and communication</li> </ul>                                                                            |
| Reporting<br>officers per<br>AoW | TBD                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Provide details of activities and results for reporting to PRMS</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

| Implementing group | Personnel | Expected roles for MELIA                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                    |           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Generate and/or compile details and evidence of results in coordination with implementing groups and key partners</li> </ul> |

See additional details in the Program's Results Framework above.

### 3. Evaluation plan

The Climate Action Program's evaluation plan integrates monitoring, evaluation, and learning (MEL) with specially designed quantitative and qualitative evaluation and impact assessment (IA) studies. It is guided by the CGIAR evaluation framework and the Quality of Research for Development (QoR4D principles). The monitoring and learning component include tracking project progress and results against established targets and impact pathways, documenting lessons learned through a specifically designed and timely learning process to guide the Program's implementation, all grounded in results-based management principles. Meanwhile, the evaluation and impact assessment studies will help us learn about our processes and outcomes and will enable us to attribute observed effects—whether positive or negative, intentional or not—to the Program. Further, this strategy allows the Program to test assumptions if they hold true and adjust the ToC to adapt to recent external contexts.

Monitoring activities will focus on documenting and reporting evidence on the activities and outputs generated by the Program and its partners. To provide management recommendations that can inform Program decisions, the MELIA team will, after conducting internal data quality control, analyze monitoring data regularly and share results with Program leaders and Areas of Work (AoW) leads. Further, once a year, results from a consolidated analysis of monitoring information will be shared with Program leaders during the Pause and Reflect planned process, to inform about our progress and how close we are to our annual targets. This will be done every year and will allow any course corrections in the Program's actions.

Regarding impact assessment, the Program will implement a set of formative and summative studies between 2025 and 2030 to document the outcomes and impacts of its interventions at different operational levels (see details in the next section). Formative evaluations will generate evidence on intermediate and 2030 outcomes, allow learning, and provide feedback to Program leaders to improve implementation. Summative studies, conducted toward the end of interventions or at Program completion (2030), will assess the Program's outcomes and impacts. Summative evaluations will be designed during the intervention planning phase—before activities are implemented—to enable baseline data collection from both potential beneficiaries and a control group, allowing us to attribute observed changes to the Program's and partners' actions (i.e., to identify causal effects).

As detailed in Annex 1, we plan to implement causal impact assessment studies, adoption studies, tracing of scaling activities and policy changes, and qualitative outcome studies. Although the MELIA studies have been identified through a consultative process with AoW leads, the results of some

studies (e.g., tracing policy changes, specific qualitative evaluations) will inform whether additional quantitative assessment studies are warranted, in which case we will design and determine how to finance their implementation. The assessment studies will evaluate the Program's contributions or effects at various levels, including farmers, FLW system and other local and national actors, finance stakeholders, and global stakeholders.

Key evaluation questions that these studies will address include:

1. Has the latest Program-generated climate science and policy informed and influenced global, regional, and national climate processes, including the UNFCCC negotiation tracks? How?
2. What is the uptake and the benefits of climate information services for farmers and rural communities, and how are these benefits differentiated across gender and socioeconomic dimensions?
3. How have the capacities of countries and humanitarian actors in early warning systems (EWS) been enhanced through CGIAR technical assistance and scientific methods and tools?
4. Which scaling pathways have been most effective in scaling LLA solutions and principles, in ways that foster accountability and transparency as well as cross-sector collaboration?
5. To what extent have dialogue platforms contributed to reducing deforestation as part of zero-deforestation supply chain efforts?
6. What is the impact of adoption of mitigation and adaptation strategies—both on-farm (e.g., irrigation and crop choice) and off-farm (e.g., domestic energy)—on food and nutritional security?
7. What are the relative contributions and mechanisms that supported increased use of climate and agricultural data in developing climate-sensitive investments?

Learning will be a continuous process throughout the Program's implementation, guided by the results generated from the comprehensive analysis of monitoring data, information recorded during strategic engagements carried out by program researchers and where emerging outcomes will be documented, and results from MELIA studies. The assessment studies will be phased over time; for example, most qualitative outcome studies will be conducted in the middle and towards the end of the Program cycle.

## Evaluation studies

As detailed in Annex 1, there are 13 MELIA studies planned to begin in 2025 (three of which began prior to the Program's official start). Of these studies, seven build on or continue previous evaluations and the same number will be implemented in collaboration with other CGIAR Science Programs (Scaling for Impact, Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods, Sustainable Farming, Food Frontiers and Security, and Digital Transformation Accelerator). Additionally, three will be led by the MELIA team in collaboration with AoW researchers, seven will be a collaborative effort led by AoW researchers with MELIA team support, and three will be implemented independently by AoW researchers with advice from the MELIA team, although their results will provide evidence towards the Program's outcomes.

Seven studies build on or continue evaluations that started before the Climate Action Science Program. The research teams responsible for three of these seven studies will complete fieldwork between 2025 and 2026 using Program resources. In particular:

1. One randomized controlled trial (RCT) in Colombia, launched toward the end of the Low Emissions Food Systems (Mitigate+) Initiative, will complete its second round of training in collaboration with Fedecacao in 2025 and collect endline survey data in 2026. This study, led by the MELIA team in collaboration with AoW4 researchers and the Scaling for Impact Program, assesses the impact of targeted training on the adoption of agroforestry practices among cacao producers. Since it began prior to the Program's start date, its results will be partially attributed to the Program.
2. A second study—also an RCT—was initiated in 2021 by AoW5 researchers to evaluate whether bundling credit with weather index insurance (WII) can significantly expand agricultural credit uptake, farm investment, and farm productivity among smallholder farmers in Kenya and Ethiopia. This study, implemented in collaboration with the Scaling for Impact Program, will conclude in 2026. Its results will partially inform the impact of the Programs but cannot be fully attributed to it.
3. A final set of studies—including RCTs and quasi-experimental designs—were launched under the bilateral AICCRA project before 2025 in three countries and will continue in AICCRA's new phase (AICCRA 3). AICCRA employs a multi-method evaluation framework integrating experimental and quasi-experimental designs to assess the impact of climate-smart agriculture (CSA) and climate information services (CIS). Selected case studies use randomized controlled trials (RCTs), propensity score matching (PSM), and spatial regression discontinuity designs to establish counterfactual comparisons. Where spatial spillovers are substantial, geospatial impact evaluations are conducted to quantify indirect benefits. Remote sensing products provide high-resolution imagery to track changes in key outcome variables across intervention areas. Country-specific studies further strengthen the analytical approach. Zambia implements an RCT focused on CIS/CSA adoption, while Ghana applies quasi-experimental methods with geospatial tools to evaluate mass media dissemination strategies. Mali conducts randomized village-level trials assessing interventions like drought-tolerant varieties, RiceAdvice, mechanization, crop diversification, CIS, and GEM parboiling. Senegal plans a quasi-experimental spatial regression discontinuity design to evaluate radio-based dissemination efforts. Across all countries, AICCRA's monitoring and adoption studies ensure systematic tracking of project indicators, supporting broader impact assessment objectives. Additionally, new studies are planned in three more countries in this new phase, focusing on estimating farmers' adoption of CIS and CSA practices.

Of the remaining 2025 studies, three (led by AoW2 researchers in collaboration with the MELIA team) will focus on estimating the adoption of weather and climate information services by farmers in different countries. These studies have been designed using insights from previous evaluations of weather and climate information services and outcome-harvesting studies conducted under former CGIAR Initiatives (AgriLAC Resiliente, ClimBeR, LCSR, and Asian Mega Deltas) as well as bilateral (AVENIR) projects. These studies will be undertaken in collaboration with the Scaling for Impact, Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods, and Sustainable Farming Science Programs. Although

additional details are not yet available, the plan is to implement these studies in a multi-year setting, collecting and reporting data annually.

Finally, one study planned for 2025—led by the MELIA team in collaboration with AoW4 researchers—was proposed in response to findings from an outcome story carried out under the Low Emissions Food Systems Initiative. That story suggested that some existing platforms had made more progress in advancing zero-deforestation supply chains than others, yet there was limited evidence of their outcomes. Accordingly, this study will document the extent to which dialogue platforms have contributed to reducing deforestation in Colombia’s dairy sector as part of zero-deforestation supply chain efforts, including the contributions of the Mitigate+ Initiative. The results will inform actions by AoW4 leaders in Colombia to enhance the climate-related outcomes of these platforms.

## Evaluation collaboration plans

Annex 1 details which of the planned MELIA studies will be implemented in collaboration with other CGIAR Programs and bilateral projects (as previously described). While not all details are available yet, by coordination we mean either coordinating the design and implementation of the studies, cofinancing them, or a combination of both. Selected examples of collaborations with other CGIAR Science Programs include:

- **Assessing the uptake** of research outputs by Climate Action researchers, CGIAR researchers, and stakeholders other than farmers. This study will be coordinated with the Policy Innovations Science Program to minimize duplication of efforts and, where feasible, collaborate on data collection.
- **Assessing the uptake** of carbon sequestration and GHG reduction solutions among FLW actors, and their estimations on the use of these solutions by end beneficiaries.
- **Estimating farmers’ use of weather and climate information in Latin America and the Caribbean (LAC).** This study will be conducted in collaboration with the Scaling for Impact Program and the Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods Program. In countries where these programs overlap, the evidence generated will contribute to documenting the outcomes of these programs as well as those of Climate Action.
- **Evaluating outcomes related to the strengthening of early warning system (EWS) capacities** for the prevention and mitigation of climate and conflict-related impacts during humanitarian emergencies. This evaluation will be coordinated with researchers from the Food Frontiers and Security Science Program.
- **Assessing global progress on National Frameworks for Climate Services (NFCS)** and building an evidence base of their benefits in Guatemala, Honduras, Colombia, and Senegal. These mixed-methods studies will be coordinated with the Scaling for Impact Program and the Digital Transformation Accelerator.

Most studies will also be implemented in collaboration with national partners. For qualitative outcome studies led by the MELIA team, local consultants will be hired to support data collection. Additionally, for quantitative evaluations requiring farmer-level data, survey firms will be contracted.

## 4. Impact assessment (IA)

As detailed above, the Climate Action Science Program will implement a set of formative and summative evaluation studies to document the outcomes and impacts of its interventions across different levels. The Program's impact assessment strategy includes studies employing qualitative (primarily), quantitative, and mixed-methods approaches, and, when feasible, methods that allow us to attribute observed results directly to the Program's actions.

The qualitative evaluations—combined with monitoring data and secondary sources—will help us identify early results most likely attributable to the Program's interventions. This evidence will also inform decisions on where and when to propose and design quantitative adoption studies or causal impact assessments. The quantitative evaluations will, in turn, provide rigorous (causal) evidence on the outcomes and impacts of the Program.

The funding mechanism to implement these studies will include a combination of direct funding from Program-allocated resources, secured funding from existing or future bilateral projects, and external sources (i.e., by preparing and submitting proposals for funding consideration).

### Program impact overview

The Climate Action Program is aligned with the Paris Agreement and CGIAR's Climate Impact Areas, particularly Climate Adaptation and Mitigation. Specifically, it aims to contribute to the reduction, avoidance, or removal of 1 gigaton of CO<sub>2</sub>e by 2030 while enhancing the resilience of small-scale producers to climate shocks and variability. This will be achieved through the sustainable adoption of climate adaptation and mitigation solutions by 16 million FLW actors across 30 priority countries. To drive these impacts, the Program employs a holistic, systems-based approach—investing in capacity building for FLW actors, creating enabling mechanisms such as data-driven climate policies, strategies, and investments, and fostering multi-stakeholder collaboration at global, regional, national, and local levels. Socially inclusive and gender-transformative capacity development, engagement models, and participatory approaches strengthen the Program's ability to enable systemic capacity change and effectively address the climate-related needs of local FLW actors.

The Program will co-develop, enhance, and scale tools, frameworks, climate information services, strategies, and socio-technological bundles to support a just transition and low-emissions climate action. Inclusive scaling of these innovations will be enabled through supportive policies, investments, and stakeholder capacities, all grounded in harmonized gender, social inclusion, and climate data derived from a more aligned climate research agenda among CGIAR and its partners. To ensure these innovations reach last-mile users, the Program will intentionally engage and empower local FLW actors—including women and youth—in identifying, designing, and implementing locally led adaptation solutions, thereby facilitating broader buy-in.

Overall, this strategy partially addresses most of the risks (assumptions) identified in the Program's Theory of Change, which largely relate to the following:

- The interests of FLW actors, including small-scale producers, in addressing climate-related risks and vulnerabilities

- Convincing FLW actors to utilize harmonized data, evidence, insights, tools, strategies, and socio-technological bundles for climate resilience
- The willingness of FLW actors to participate in capacity development and engagement activities
- The presence of enabling mechanisms such as complementary resources (capacity development, infrastructure, finance), supportive policies, and a conducive political environment

## IA activities and collaboration plans

The overall ambition of the Climate Action Program is to deliver the science, innovation, and collaboration needed to transform FLW systems into climate-resilient, net-zero, and equitable systems. This ambition will be achieved through the actions of five AoWs that operate at micro (farmers, local stakeholders), meso (sub-national), macro (national, regional), and global levels. AoW 1 helps set climate change priorities for CGIAR and global partners with a complementary synthesis role (macro and global levels). AoWs 2, 3, and 4 drive on-the-ground adaptation and mitigation action, also linking to other Programs and Accelerators at all levels (micro, meso, macro and global). AoW 5 provides an enabling environment for scaling through policy and finance (macro and global levels).

To support this ambition, the Program will draw on evidence from a set of studies designed to measure its contributions and impacts across different levels. These studies will focus on high-potential interventions and key questions prioritized by partners and aligned with the Program's 2030 outcomes. This approach will include:

- Using evidence from evaluation studies planned by AoWs as a baseline for future impact assessment or as evidence of impacts (with guidance from the MELIA team to ensure consistency with CGIAR indicators and methods)
- Collaborating with AoWs or Bilateral project teams to implement already planned studies (with MELIA team support in the design and other stages as needed); and
- Designing and implementing specific MELIA-led studies in close coordination with AoW researchers.

The program's IA strategy includes implementing three causal impact assessment studies; six adoption studies; one tracing of scaling activities and policy advice study; and 11 qualitative outcome studies. These studies were selected because they allow us to document the Program's contributions to outcomes and, in some cases, attribute observed changes to the Program using experimental and quasi-experimental methods.

Given the Program's wide geographic scope—spanning 71 countries including all funding sources—the specific locations for MELIA studies will be determined or confirmed in 2025. For studies that are not already in AoW workplans or linked to bilateral projects, selection criteria will include:

- Countries with overlapping AoW, other Science Program, and bilateral project activities.
- Countries with existing or ongoing evaluations; and
- Countries where larger impacts are expected.



This prioritization is essential given the limited human and financial resources available for implementing these studies.

The Program plans to collaborate with seven Science Programs and one bilateral project in implementing the proposed MELIA studies. The collaboration with bilateral projects will most likely change over time, as these projects are secured or completed. In total, 12 studies will be implemented in collaboration with other Science Programs, and one study—implemented by AICCRA—will include evaluations in six countries. Collaborating with other science programs will include coordinating the design and implementation of specific studies, co-financing studies, or a combination of both. For the remaining eight studies, no collaborations have yet been identified, but this decision will be revisited during the design phase, as collaboration can help pool resources and improve efficiency.

## IA studies

Following a consultative process with AoW leaders, we have identified 21 studies that will generate evidence on intermediate and 2030 outcomes. Although these are preliminary and subject to change (depending on factors such as funding availability), details for each study are provided in Annex 1.

Of the 21 studies:

- Seven are already included in the AoWs' workplans and will proceed without direct MELIA team involvement but with the MELIA team's guidance (case i).
- Seven will be led by AoW or bilateral project researchers, with support from the MELIA team (case ii).
- Seven will be designed and implemented by the MELIA team (case iii).

Regarding methods:

- Four studies will use quantitative methods only.
- Nine will use qualitative methods only.
- Eight will employ mixed methods.

In terms of outcomes:

- One study will focus solely on intermediate outcomes.
- Sixteen studies will address 2030 outcomes.
- Four studies will cover both intermediate and 2030 outcomes.

Additionally, of the 21 studies:

- Four were designed based on results from previous evaluations conducted under CGIAR Initiatives (Mitigate+, ClimBeR, Asian Mega Deltas, AgriLAC Resiliente, and LCSR), and one of these was also informed from results from a bilateral project (AVENIR).
- One includes a baseline study implemented under the Mitigate+ Initiative, with the endline planned for 2026.
- One study began a year prior to the Initiatives and will be completed under the Climate Action Program, with the endline also planned for 2026.
- One was initiated by the bilateral project AICCRA.

## 5. Learning and adaptive management

### Learning

As detailed above, the program will implement four types of MELIA studies and will also conduct analysis of the monitoring data. The causal impact assessment studies will provide evidence on the impact (intended or not) of the program, and results will be used to inform program implementation, once they become available. This will be possible because two of these studies will be completed by 2026. The adoption or diffusion studies, which will be implemented in different years between 2025-2030, will provide evidence about the uptake of Program outputs and allow Program management to realignment actions where adoption is lacking or minimal. Tracing scaling activities and policy advice will allow us to continuously monitor and document how our actions are influencing stakeholders' decisions. Together with qualitative outcome evaluations (which will be implemented between 2025-2030), this information will allow us to determine when a quantitative evaluation study is required. For example, if finance stakeholders increase the funding available to invest in climate solutions, because of the evidence generated by the Program, and borrowers are using this credit, we could design and implement a quantitative study to evaluate the impact of these actions on farmers and the environment. All the knowledge generated by these studies will be available not only to Program managers, but also researchers, the CGIAR community, and external stakeholders.

Finally, analyzing monitoring data will be a continuous process, and results, along with recommendations, will be made available to Program managers to make any necessary adjustments to the Program implementation.

### Annual review and adaptive planning

The Climate Action Program will implement an annual review and adaptive planning process, building on the experience and lessons from the 2022–24 CGIAR Portfolio and aligned with evolving guidance on the Reflect and Re-Plan processes.

Each year, the Program will conduct structured annual performance reviews at both program-wide and AoW levels. These reviews will assess progress toward the intended outputs and outcomes, using both quantitative and qualitative data drawn from the CGIAR Performance and Results Management System (PRMS). This system will serve as the core data infrastructure for tracking key indicators, reporting performance, and generating insights to support decision-making. The Program will also look at opportunities for better collaboration with other Science Programs and their contributions to Climate Action activities, outputs and outcomes.

The performance review will include the following elements:

- Tracking delivery against annual workplans, milestones, and deliverables.
- Evaluating contributions toward short- and intermediate-term outcomes, with attention to assumptions and risks identified in the Theory of Change.
- Assessing progress on gender and social inclusion indicators, disaggregated data use, and outcomes aligned with the Just Transition and GESI frameworks.

- Finance and Resource Utilization Review: Reviewing how resource allocations supported or constrained progress, to inform reprioritization if needed.
- Partner Engagement Review: Reflecting on co-design, uptake, and collaboration dynamics with key partners including NARES, governments, and private sector actors.

Findings from the performance review will directly inform the adaptive planning process, including:

- Adjustments to AoW-level priorities and delivery strategies.
- Realignment of resource allocations and timelines.
- Revision of assumptions and mitigation strategies within the Program's Theory of Change.
- Revisions to MELIA strategies (e.g., adding or refining indicators, baselines, or learning questions).

The adaptive planning process will be participatory and inclusive, ensuring the engagement of AoW leads, MELIA focal points, and key program stakeholders. Outputs from this process will include an annual adaptive management plan that documents changes in direction, resourcing, or approach, and outlines clear rationales grounded in evidence.

This annual cycle of reflect–re-plan–adjust is integral to the Program's learning culture and its commitment to transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement.

## 6. Reporting

The Program's MELIA team will design an online, user-friendly system (i.e., templates, file structures, etc.) to encourage real-time reporting of monitoring data and results. Reporting templates will include smart and contextual cues to help research teams document not only results, but also key decisions, implementation challenges, and signals of change as they emerge. AoW leads (or designated person) will submit data on a rolling basis. The MELIA and Program management teams will conduct quarterly validations and entry into the PRMS system to avoid year-end data backlogs. Reporting will align with the CGIAR Technical Reporting Arrangement (TRA) 2025–30 and quality assurance process.

## 7. MELIA resources

### MELIA budget and staff

The MELIA team consists of researchers responsible for monitoring, evaluation, and learning (MEL) activities as well as impact assessment (IA) activities. The team is organized as follows:

#### **MEL team:**

- Composed of a focal point, Valerien Pede, and a senior specialist, Justin Dela Rueda—both based in the Philippines.
- The focal point oversees the overall MEL activities in the science program including, ToC formulation and revision, CGIAR technical reporting, monitoring activities, documenting and

assessing results, contributing to adaptive planning and reflect processes, engagement with AoW leads, and ensuring coordination with the IA team and key stakeholders. The focal point will dedicate 50% of his time annually to these activities.

- The senior specialist is responsible for supporting the MEL Focal Point in ensuring timely conduct of MEL activities and corresponding MEL outputs. He will ensure that MEL outputs are communicated to the implementation team and key stakeholders whenever possible. He will provide focused support in the entire CG technical reporting process.

#### **IA team:**

- Composed of a focal point, Byron Reyes (based in Honduras); a senior scientist, Enoch Kikulwe (based in Kenya); and a research associate, Karen Camilo (based in Colombia).
- The IA focal point oversees the implementation of the MELIA Plan in coordination with the MEL focal point; guides the design and coordination of MELIA-led evaluations and assessment studies; supports the MEL team in revisions of the ToC based on MELIA study results, contributes to adaptive planning and reflect processes, and engages with Program and AoW leadership to support reporting and learning processes, with a focus on outcomes and impacts. He will dedicate 50% of his time to the Program.
- The senior scientist collaborates closely with the IA focal point on designing and implementing MELIA-led studies, leads specific evaluations implemented through bilateral projects (e.g., AICCRA), and contributes to all planned studies, dedicating 20% of his time to the Program.
- The research associate coordinates field activities for MELIA studies; liaises with local partners; oversees data collection; leads data cleaning and analysis; and contributes to research outputs. She will dedicate 77% of her time to the Program in 2025, with her involvement expected to increase in future years as the number of MELIA studies implemented increase.

Both teams will work closely and collaboratively to ensure that the MELIA Plan is implemented as designed, and to provide technical support to Program leaders, researchers, and partners as needed.

In addition to the core teams, the Program has an extended MELIA team composed of experts from the Program. They are Todd Rosenstock and John Choptiany, who provide guidance and recommendations regarding MEL and IA activities, processes, and studies.

The MELIA staff's budget for 2025 is US\$319,033, and we are assuming this cost will increase annually by 3.5% (Annex 2). No pooled was provided for MEL or IA operations at the PMU level; however, we understand that additional resources are available through center budgets and bilateral projects, although the total amount cannot be estimated at this time (Annex 3).

## 8. Data management

### General approach

Data management in the Climate Action Program will move beyond compliance reporting to actively support learning, adaptation, and accountability. Monitoring data will be submitted by Area of Work (AoW) teams through an online, user-friendly template designed by the MELIA team to encourage real-time reporting. Templates will include smart prompts and contextual cues to help research teams document not only results, but also key decisions, implementation challenges, and signals of change as they emerge.

Data submission will occur on a rolling basis, supported by automated quality checks and centralized review from the MELIA and Program management teams. Quarterly validation and entry into the PRMS system will help maintain momentum and avoid year-end data backlogs, while also enabling continuous insight generation.

In line with CGIAR's Open and FAIR Data Assets Policy, databases generated by research teams will be managed by those teams with the assumption of eventual publication. The MELIA team will promote a bias toward timely release of datasets and insights, with embargoes or delays only where ethically or strategically necessary. Data from MELIA-led studies will be shared after associated publications, or sooner if feasible, and stored securely until publication. Platforms such as Dataverse and CGSpace will be used to ensure public access and discoverability.

To capture the processes of change, the MELIA team will pilot complementary documentation tools such as periodic team check-ins, short audio or text narratives, and integration of feedback loops from partner organizations. These innovations will allow the program to document adaptation, iteration, and institutional learning—not just fixed results—creating a rich evidence base for ongoing improvement and broader replication.

## 9. Annexes

# Annex 1. Proposed MELIA studies

| MELIA Study title                                                                                                                                                | MELIA type                                                             | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                           | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                      | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Location | Country                                                       | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s) | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others)          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| AICCRA's assessments of CIS and CSA in Senegal, Mali, Ghana, Kenya, Ethiopia, Zambia                                                                             | Causal Impact Assessment learning studies                              | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Enoch Kikulwe ( <a href="mailto:e.kikulwe@cgiar.org">e.kikulwe@cgiar.org</a> )    | • 2030 Outcome - 1 Small-scale producers and other actors use climate advisory services, early warning or adaptive safety nets                                                        | • Number of small-scale producers and/or other FLW system actors using climate services, EWS, or adaptive safety nets                                                                                                                                     | • Regulatory environments enable innovation in water governance and management.<br>• Data, tools, and methods are relevant to sector needs and local context; and services are relevant, trusted, and usable by diverse producer groups. | country  | •Ethiopia<br>•Senegal<br>•Mali<br>•Zambia<br>•Ghana<br>•Kenya |        | Quantitative method           | Scaling for Impact Program        | 2025                     | 2030                   |                  | Started under AICCRA AF and will continue in AICCRA III |
| Assessing the global progress of NFCS frameworks and evidence base of their benefits in Zambia                                                                   | Qualitative outcome study                                              | International Water Management Institute                                  | Giriraj Amarnath ( <a href="mailto:a.giriraj@cgiar.org">a.giriraj@cgiar.org</a> ) | • 2030 Outcome - 3 Integrated climate risk management strategies and roadmaps supported by partners                                                                                   | • Number of climate risk management strategies, roadmaps, or National Frameworks supported or informed with CG data and evidence                                                                                                                          | • Political and institutional alignment enables cross-sectoral climate risk planning.<br>• Strategies are sufficiently funded and monitored for implementation.                                                                          | country  | • Zambia                                                      |        | Mixed methods                 | Capacity Sharing Accelerator      | 2026                     | 2027                   | TBD              | N/A                                                     |
| Assessing CGIAR contributions to UNFCCC discussions using large language models or text analysis, and their effect on global stakeholders' narrative and actions | Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC | International Livestock Research Institute                                | Aditi Mukherji ( <a href="mailto:a.mukherji@cgiar.org">a.mukherji@cgiar.org</a> ) | • Intermediate Outcome - 1.3. Informed high-level and global climate processes and negotiations<br>• 2030 Outcome - 11 Climate related policies informed by climate data and evidence | • Number of outcome documents, decision texts and summary documents of global climate processes (e.g., UNFCCC/ COP Presidencies) informed by CGIAR's harmonized data and evidence<br>• Number of climate/related policies using climate data and evidence | • Policymakers want to access and use climate data in their decisions<br>• Reliable evidence is accessible, and there is a commitment to integrating it into policy and investment decisions                                             | global   |                                                               |        | Quantitative method           |                                   | 2025                     | 2030                   | TBD              | N/A                                                     |

| MELIA Study title                                                                                                                                | MELIA type                | Lead Center                                                              | Contact                                                                             | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Location | Country                                              | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s)                              | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others) |
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| Assessing the global progress of NFCS frameworks and evidence base of their benefits in Guatemala, Honduras, Colombia and Senegal                | Qualitative outcome study | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarter (Bioversity International) | Carlos Navarro ( <a href="mailto:c.e.navarro@cgiar.org">c.e.navarro@cgiar.org</a> ) | • 2030 Outcome - 3 Integrated climate risk management strategies and roadmaps supported by partners                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | • Number of climate risk management strategies, roadmaps, or National Frameworks supported or informed with CG data and evidence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | • Political and institutional alignment enables cross-sectoral climate risk planning.<br>• Strategies are sufficiently funded and monitored for implementation.                                                                                                                                                                  | country  | • Honduras<br>• Guatemala<br>• Senegal<br>• Colombia |        | Mixed methods                 | Scaling for Impact Program, Digital Transformation Accelerator | 2026                     | 2029                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |
| Assessing the influence of the Climate Action Program in financing decisions related to investing in LLA solutions and other program innovations | Qualitative outcome study | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarter (Bioversity International) | Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> )            | • Intermediate Outcome - 5.1. Actors use CGIAR data, information and tools in climate policy design<br>• 2030 Outcome - 10 Actors mobilize finance for just, low-emission and climate resilience projects<br>• 2030 Outcome - 5 Actors mobilize new finance for locally-led climate adaptation<br>• 2030 Outcome - 8 Partners and other actors mobilize finance to support low-emissions | • Amount of investments made by public/private sector actors to support just, low-emission/climate resilience projects<br>• Amount of investments made by government/development partners/private sector actors for low-emissions informed by CG science and evidence<br>• Number of projects financing locally led climate adaptation and mitigation<br>• Number of actors reporting use of CGIAR-informed data, information and tool in designing climate and related policies (disaggregated by type of actor, institution) | • LLA methodologies meet partners' needs; national and international organizations are motivated to support LLA<br>• Socio-technological bundles receive positive feedback from producers and other stakeholders (are aligned with development priorities, have effective business models attached, bring along other benefits). | global   |                                                      |        | Qualitative method            |                                                                | 2027                     | 2030                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |

| MELIA Study title                                                                                                                          | MELIA type                | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                           | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Location | Country                                                                                                          | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s)   | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Assessing the uptake of outputs by Climate Action, CGIAR, and stakeholders other than farmers.                                             | Qualitative outcome study | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> )          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 11 Climate related policies informed by climate data and evidence</li> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 4 Producers and other food, land, water system actors adopt locally-led adaptation solutions</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Number of climate/related policies using climate data and evidence</li> <li>• Number of partners directly supporting smallholder producers adopting locally-led adaptation solutions</li> <li>• Number of FLW system actors (aside from smallholder producers) adopting/supporting locally-led adaptation solutions</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Reliable evidence is accessible, and there is a commitment to integrating it into policy and investment decisions</li> <li>• Governments and stakeholders prioritize climate action and are willing to collaborate with CGIAR for policy and investment improvements</li> </ul> | regional |                                                                                                                  | TBD    | Qualitative method            | Policy Innovation's Science Program | 2027                     | 2029                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |
| Assessing the uptake of carbon sequestration and GHG reduction solutions among FLW actors, and their perceived uptake by end beneficiaries | Qualitative outcome study | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> )          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 11 Climate related policies informed by climate data and evidence</li> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 4 Producers and other food, land, water system actors adopt locally-led adaptation solutions</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Number of climate/related policies using climate data and evidence</li> <li>• Number of partners directly supporting smallholder producers adopting locally-led adaptation solutions</li> <li>• Number of FLW system actors (aside from smallholder producers) adopting/supporting locally-led adaptation solutions</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Reliable evidence is accessible, and there is a commitment to integrating it into policy and investment decisions</li> <li>• Governments and stakeholders prioritize climate action and are willing to collaborate with CGIAR for policy and investment improvements</li> </ul> | regional |                                                                                                                  | •TBD   | Qualitative method            |                                     | 2027                     | 2029                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |
| Estimating the use and benefits of the AWARE platform for disaster preparedness and response                                               | Qualitative outcome study | International Water Management Institute                                  | Giriraj Amarnath ( <a href="mailto:a.giriraj@cgiar.org">a.giriraj@cgiar.org</a> ) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 2 Countries and humanitarian actors enhance and use early warning systems and adaptive safety nets</li> </ul>                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Number of countries and humanitarian actors using enhanced EWS and safety nets</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Sufficient resourcing is available for inclusive co-design processes.</li> <li>• Institutional mandates align with anticipatory action and early response.</li> </ul>                                                                                                           | country  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Kenya</li> <li>• Pakistan</li> <li>• India</li> <li>• Zambia</li> </ul> |        | Mixed methods                 |                                     | 2026                     | 2027                   |                  |                                                |



| MELIA Study title                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MELIA type                                                             | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                             | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                               | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                             | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                        | Location | Country                                                                                         | Region                                                                                                                                        | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s)                                        | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others)                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Estimating the use of CGIAR-informed guidelines, tools, and assessment frameworks for the co-design of integrated national strategies for climate risk management (ICRM) that address the compounding risks arising from climate change and social insecurities | Qualitative outcome study                                              | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Grazia Pacillo ( <a href="mailto:g.pacillo@cgiar.org">g.pacillo@cgiar.org</a> )     | • 2030 Outcome - 3 Integrated climate risk management strategies and roadmaps supported by partners                            | • Number of climate risk management strategies, roadmaps, or National Frameworks supported or informed with CG data and evidence | • Policymakers want to access and use climate data in their decisions<br>• Strategies are sufficiently funded and monitored for implementation.                                                                             | regional |                                                                                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Western Asia</li> <li>• Eastern Africa</li> <li>• Southern Africa</li> <li>• Central Asia</li> </ul> | Qualitative method            | Food Frontiers and Security Science Program                              | 2026                     | 2029                   | TBD              | N/A                                                                                                                       |
| Estimating weather and climate information use by farmers in ESA                                                                                                                                                                                                | Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Aniruddha Ghosh ( <a href="mailto:a.ghosh@cgiar.org">a.ghosh@cgiar.org</a> )        | • 2030 Outcome - 1 Small-scale producers and other actors use climate advisory services, early warning or adaptive safety nets | • Number of small-scale producers and/or other FLW system actors using climate services, EWS, or adaptive safety nets            | • Data, tools, and methods are relevant to sector needs and local context; and services are relevant, trusted, and usable by diverse producer groups.<br>• Delivery channels (digital, radio, extension) function reliably. | country  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Ethiopia</li> <li>• Kenya</li> <li>• Zambia</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                               | Mixed methods                 | Scaling for Impact Program, Sustainable Farming Program                  | 2025                     | 2029                   | TBD              | N/A                                                                                                                       |
| Estimating weather and climate information use by farmers in LAC                                                                                                                                                                                                | Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Carlos Navarro ( <a href="mailto:c.e.navarro@cgiar.org">c.e.navarro@cgiar.org</a> ) | • 2030 Outcome - 1 Small-scale producers and other actors use climate advisory services, early warning or adaptive safety nets | • Number of small-scale producers and/or other FLW system actors using climate services, EWS, or adaptive safety nets            | • Data, tools, and methods are relevant to sector needs and local context; and services are relevant, trusted, and usable by diverse producer groups.<br>• Delivery channels (digital, radio, extension) function reliably. | regional |                                                                                                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Latin America and the Caribbean</li> </ul>                                                           | Mixed methods                 | Scaling for Impact Program, Sustainable Animal and Aquatic Foods Program | 2025                     | 2029                   | TBD              | WCIS evaluations and outcome harvesting studies in LAC, including under ClimBeR, AgriLAC Resiliente, and LCSR initiatives |

| MELIA Study title                                                                    | MELIA type                                                             | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                                                                                                              | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                               | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                  | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                        | Location | Country                                               | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s)  | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others)                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Estimating weather and climate information use by farmers in Senegal                 | Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | Issa Ouedraogo ( <a href="mailto:I.Ouedraogo@cgiar.org">I.Ouedraogo@cgiar.org</a> )                                                                                  | • 2030 Outcome - 1 Small-scale producers and other actors use climate advisory services, early warning or adaptive safety nets | • Number of small-scale producers and/or other FLW system actors using climate services, EWS, or adaptive safety nets | • Data, tools, and methods are relevant to sector needs and local context; and services are relevant, trusted, and usable by diverse producer groups.<br>• Delivery channels (digital, radio, extension) function reliably. | country  | • Senegal                                             |        | Mixed methods                 |                                    | 2025                     | 2029                   | TBD              | WCIS evaluations and outcome harvesting studies in Senegal, including under ClimBeR and LCSR initiatives and bilateral project AVENIR. |
| Estimating weather and climate information use by farmers in Vietnam and Philippines | Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC | International Rice Research Institute                                     | Alice Laborte ( <a href="mailto:a.g.laborte@cgiar.org">a.g.laborte@cgiar.org</a> )<br>Cornelis Swaans ( <a href="mailto:c.swaans@cgiar.org">c.swaans@cgiar.org</a> ) | • 2030 Outcome - 1 Small-scale producers and other actors use climate advisory services, early warning or adaptive safety nets | • Number of small-scale producers and/or other FLW system actors using climate services, EWS, or adaptive safety nets | • Data, tools, and methods are relevant to sector needs and local context; and services are relevant, trusted, and usable by diverse producer groups.<br>• Delivery channels (digital, radio, extension) function reliably. | country  | • The Socialist Republic of Viet Nam<br>• Philippines |        | Mixed methods                 | Scaling for Impact Program         | 2025                     | 2029                   | TBD              | Prior WCIS evaluations in the Philippines and Vietnam from ClimBeR, and Asian Mega Deltas initiatives                                  |
| Estimating weather and climate information use in Sri Lanka                          | Adoption or diffusion studies addressing learning questions on the TOC | International Water Management Institute                                  | Giriraj Amarnath ( <a href="mailto:a.giriraj@cgiar.org">a.giriraj@cgiar.org</a> )                                                                                    | • 2030 Outcome - 1 Small-scale producers and other actors use climate advisory services, early warning or adaptive safety nets | • Number of small-scale producers and/or other FLW system actors using climate services, EWS, or adaptive safety nets | • Data, tools, and methods are relevant to sector needs and local context; and services are relevant, trusted, and usable by diverse producer groups.<br>• Delivery channels (digital, radio, extension) function reliably. | country  | • Sri Lanka                                           |        | Mixed methods                 | Digital Transformation Accelerator | 2025                     | 2026                   | TBD              | N/A                                                                                                                                    |

| MELIA Study title                                                                                                                                 | MELIA type                                | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                           | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                                                                  | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                   | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Location | Country               | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s)           | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others)                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------------------|--------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Evaluating the impacts of an insurance-linked credit program among smallholder farmers in Ethiopia and Kenya                                      | Causal Impact Assessment learning studies | International Food Policy Research Institute                              | Liangzhi You ( <a href="mailto:lyou@cgiar.org">lyou@cgiar.org</a> )               | • Intermediate Outcome - 5.3. Access to new climate financing models and carbon markets                                                                           | • Number of public/private actors accessing new climate financing models/carbon markets                                                                                                                | • Access to reliable data and expertise, adequate resources, training, and institutional support are provided                                                                                                                                                                                                   | country  | • Ethiopia<br>• Kenya |        | Quantitative method           | Scaling for Impact Program                  | 2025                     | 2026                   | TBD              | This evaluation was started prior to the program and the former initiatives. It will partially evidence the impact of the program (but cannot be attributed to it entirely)                   |
| Impact assessment of agroforestry training in the adoption of agroforestry practices and farm outcomes in Colombia                                | Causal Impact Assessment learning studies | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | • Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> )        | • 2030 Outcome - 7 Actors adopt solutions to sequester carbon and to reduce greenhouse gas emissions                                                              | • Number of smallholder producers adopting solutions to sequester carbon/reduce greenhouse gas<br>• Area under improved agronomy/management for carbon sequestration/reducing greenhouse gas emissions | • Socio-technological bundles receive positive feedback from producers and other stakeholders (are aligned with development priorities, have effective business models attached, bring along other benefits).<br>• Solutions developed for action are supported by incentives, available finance, and policies. | country  | • Colombia            |        | Quantitative method           | Scaling for Impact Program                  | 2025                     | 2026                   |                  | Baseline and first training round implemented under Mitigate+ Initiative. Budget not secured yet and only refers to field activities for second round of training and endline data collection |
| Outcomes of strengthening of EWS capacities for prevention and mitigation of climate and conflict-related impacts during humanitarian emergencies | Qualitative outcome study                 | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | • Grazia Pacillo ( <a href="mailto:g.pacillo@cgiar.org">g.pacillo@cgiar.org</a> ) | • Intermediate Outcome - 2.2 Strengthened capacities for early warning, detection, communication, preparedness, and targeting<br>• 2030 Outcome - 2 Countries and | • Number of countries and humanitarian actors using enhanced EWS and safety nets<br>• Number of institutions with improved early warning systems (EWS) and risk                                        | • Government and humanitarian actors prioritize multi-hazard risk management.<br>• Institutional mandates align with anticipatory action and early response.                                                                                                                                                    | global   |                       |        | Qualitative method            | Food Frontiers and Security Science Program | 2025                     | 2026                   | TBD              | N/A                                                                                                                                                                                           |

| MELIA Study title                                                                                                                                           | MELIA type                | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                    | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                              | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                              | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Location | Country    | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s) | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others) |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------|--------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                             |                           |                                                                           |                                                                            | humanitarian actors enhance and use early warning systems and adaptive safety nets                            | communication capacity                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |          |            |        |                               |                                   |                          |                        |                  |                                                |
| Outcomes of the Climate Action Science Program on the co-design, implementation, and scaling of LLA solutions; and on the uptake of adaptation pathways and | Qualitative outcome study | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | • Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> ) | • 2030 Outcome - 4 Producers and other food, land, water system actors adopt locally-led adaptation solutions | • Number of FLW system actors (aside from smallholder producers) adopting/supporting locally-led adaptation solutions<br>• Number of partners directly supporting smallholder producers adopting locally-led adaptation solutions | • Locally led adaptation is widely picked up by the climate and development community                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | regional |            |        | Qualitative method            |                                   | 2027                     | 2029                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |
| The Role of Dialogue Platforms in Advancing Zero-Deforestation Supply Chains in Colombia: The Case of the Dairy Sector                                      | Qualitative outcome study | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | • Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> ) | • 2030 Outcome - 7 Actors adopt solutions to sequester carbon and to reduce greenhouse gas emissions          | • Number of smallholder producers adopting solutions to sequester carbon/reduce greenhouse gas<br>• Area under improved agronomy/management for carbon sequestration/reducing greenhouse gas emissions                            | • Socio-technological bundles receive positive feedback from producers and other stakeholders (are aligned with development priorities, have effective business models attached, bring along other benefits).<br>• Solutions developed for action are supported by incentives, available finance, and policies. | country  | • Colombia |        | Qualitative method            |                                   | 2025                     | 2025                   |                  | One outcome story developed under Mitigate+.   |

| MELIA Study title                                                                                    | MELIA type                                                                                               | Lead Center                                                               | Contact                                                                                  | Result(s) Type and Title evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Indicator(s) evidenced by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Assumption(s) assessed by this study                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Location | Country | Region | Methods and design approaches | Other Program(s) / Accelerator(s) | Start date for the study | End date for the study | Study cost (USD) | How related to past evaluations (SG or others) |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|--------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Tracing the Climate Action Program's influence on NDCs and policies                                  | Tracing of scaling activities and policy advice, as a base for long-term, large scale impact assessments | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | • Byron Reyes ( <a href="mailto:b.reyes@cgiar.org">b.reyes@cgiar.org</a> )               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Intermediate Outcome - 5.1. Actors use CGIAR data, information and tools in climate policy design</li> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 11 Climate related policies informed by climate data and evidence</li> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 9 Nationally determined contributions (NDCs) for low-emissions</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Number of climate/related policies using climate data and evidence</li> <li>• Number of NDCs supporting low-emissions informed by CG science and evidence</li> <li>• Number of actors reporting use of CGIAR-informed data, information and tool in designing climate and related policies (disaggregated by type of actor, institution)</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Incentives exist for partners to want to track climate action</li> <li>• Access to reliable data and expertise, adequate resources, training, and institutional support are provided</li> <li>• Reliable evidence is accessible, and there is a commitment to integrating it into policy and investment decisions</li> </ul> | global   |         |        | Qualitative method            |                                   | 2025                     | 2030                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |
| Use of Africa Agriculture Adaptation Atlas data by investors to inform US\$ 2 billion in investments | Qualitative outcome study                                                                                | Alliance of Bioversity and CIAT - Headquarters (Bioversity International) | • Todd Rosenstock ( <a href="mailto:t.rosenstock@cgiar.org">t.rosenstock@cgiar.org</a> ) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 2030 Outcome - 10 Actors mobilize finance for just, low-emission and climate resilience projects</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Amount of investments made by public/private sector actors to support just, low-emission/climate resilience projects</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Policymakers want to access and use climate data in their decisions</li> <li>• Reliable evidence is accessible, and there is a commitment to integrating it into policy and investment decisions</li> </ul>                                                                                                                  | regional |         |        | Qualitative method            |                                   | 2025                     | 2025                   | TBD              | N/A                                            |

*Annex 2. MELIA budget: Staff costs*

| Item / USD      | 2025           | 2026           | 2027           | 2028           | 2029           | 2030           |
|-----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| MEL staff costs | 130,573        | 135,143        | 139,873        | 144,769        | 149,836        | 155,080        |
| IA staff costs  | 188,460        | 195,056        | 201,883        | 208,949        | 216,262        | 223,831        |
| <b>Total</b>    | <b>319,033</b> | <b>330,199</b> | <b>341,756</b> | <b>353,718</b> | <b>366,098</b> | <b>378,911</b> |

*Assumes an increase of 3.5 percent per year.*

*Annex 3. MELIA budget: Total cost*

| Item / USD                  | 2025           | 2026           | 2027           | 2028           | 2029           | 2030           |
|-----------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| MEL staff costs             | 130,573        | 135,143        | 139,873        | 144,769        | 149,836        | 155,080        |
| MEL operations <sup>a</sup> | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              |
| IA staff costs              | 188,460        | 195,056        | 201,883        | 208,949        | 216,262        | 223,831        |
| IA operations <sup>a</sup>  | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              | -              |
| <b>Total</b>                | <b>319,033</b> | <b>330,199</b> | <b>341,756</b> | <b>353,718</b> | <b>366,098</b> | <b>378,911</b> |

<sup>a</sup> No pooled funding was provided for MEL or IA operations at the PMU level; however, we understand that additional resources are available through Center budgets and bilateral projects, although the total amount cannot be estimated at this time.